



Antigua and
Barbuda



Bahamas



Barbados

MEXICO, CENTRAL AMERICA, & THE CARIBBEAN

Central America is made up of a narrow strip of eight countries that link the continents of North and South America. Just like the long chain of islands that makes up the Caribbean, Central America is surrounded by clear blue oceans. Today, the beautiful Caribbean Sea and the sunny, sandy beaches attract many tourists. In the past, the sea brought visitors who were less welcome, like the Conquistadors and colonizers from Europe 500 years ago.

Weaving for a living

About 40 percent of the people of Guatemala are Amerindian. Their ancestors go back a thousand years to the days of the ancient Maya. Guatemala now sells Mayan crafts to the rest of the world.

*Horizontal
weaving loom*

*The end of
the loom is
tied to a tree.*



Carnival time

The Caribbean is famous for its carnivals. For two days and nights just before the Christian festival of Lent, people dance through the streets wearing fantastic costumes.

*It is often possible to tell
which village a weaver
lives in from the patterns
in her cloth.*

*A strap around the
weaver's back holds
the loom steady.*

